

DVD disparity

Hello sir,

Thank you for the most useless thing I ever got. Not a single person I know has a DVD-ROM drive. Can you imagine the frustration? None the less, it was good thinking to give us poor readers such valuable programs and OS's that we cannot use!

[Naved](#)

Via e-mail

Hi Digit,

I have been reading Digit for a number of years, and compliment you for the excellent coverage. So, at first glance, I was very happy to see Linux software with your Aug 03 issue, but was disappointed and disheartened to find that these are on DVD, and not a CD. I am sure you know that most of us have CD-ROMs! Hence, you have disappointed us. Please carry the Linux distributions on future CDs.

[Colonel JK Maindiratta](#)

Via e-mail

Dear Sir,

What made you think that the majority of your readers have DVD drives?

[Gopal Goswami](#)

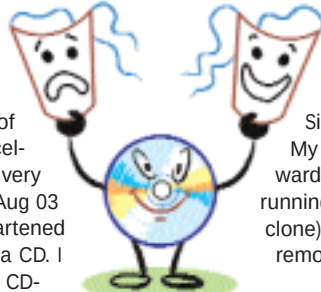
Via e-mail

Sumod,

Thanks for the Linux DVD. We hope that Digit will maintain its trendsetting ways by moving away from CDs, and bundling only DVDs with every issue. You are also helping the environment by bundling 4.7 GB worth of software on one disk, instead of many. I liked Vipul Shah's column on spam, and look forward to more. Also, please devote an article to GPRS, and tell us more about the handsets and services available.

[Meeta P Doshi](#)

Via e-mail



ILLUSTRATIONS: Mahesh Benkar

Sir,

My congratulations to you on the wonderful DVD, I was looking forward to the Linux issue for many months. I've installed Red Hat, and it's running perfectly. This e-mail is sent using Ximian Evolution (an Outlook clone) that I got from your DVD. You should have covered installing and removing applications a little more. Also, many applications that you gave in the software section of the DVD were already in the distributions—Evolution, for example. You could have used

that space to give us some more goodies!

[Hari Krishna P](#)

Via e-mail

Hi,

I am a subscriber of Digit and a true fan. Keep it up! Please review DVD-Writers, as I am sure many of us are eagerly awaiting that.

[Sarfaraz Khan](#)

Via e-mail

No, all our readers don't have DVD drives. Just as all our readers didn't have CD-ROM drives when this magazine was launched. We can't do justice to the potential and diversity of Linux, by bundling a CD or two. For those of us who can remember the 40+ floppies required to install any significant software 10 years ago, this is a familiar situation. With DVD drives priced competitively, the time is ripe for a switch, and given the volume of e-mail we received, we sure seemed to have stirred up a lot of discussion on this issue. While we do not have any plans to replace the regular two free CDs with a DVD any time soon, we do look forward to when we can.

Thanks for the pointer Rajesh. Though this method involves the dreaded 'command line', it does indeed eliminate the need to write CDs. We have a complete step-by-step workshop for doing this on www.thinkdigit.com for those of our readers who feel comfortable with a text mode Linux install process.

Linux know-how

Hi Digit,

Your DVD rockz... Red Hat and Mandrake in one DVD plus other distributions.

I just wanted to let readers know that it is possible to install some ISOs, without actually burning them to a CD. With Red Hat it's simple, just extract the 'dosutils' directory from the first ISO, and run autoboot.bat, or loadlin with params, in DOS. With Mandrake, you need to extract the whole ISO, create a bootable floppy with hd.img using rawwrite, boot from the floppy and point to the partition where you've extracted the ISO. With Peanut, I think you can use the ram.bat (I haven't tried this). You can use Winiso, or any similar utility to extract ISOs. This should be good for people with DVD drives, and large hard disks.

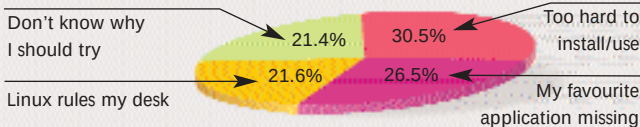
[Rajesh Goli](#)

Via e-mail

digit READER POLLS

Your vote counts

Q. Your reason for not trying out Linux yet...



Response: 1,940

This month's question:

Question: What is your primary means of Internet access?

- Dial-up
- Broadband
- Mobile phone

Log on to www.thinkdigit.com and vote